Pairing Bluetooth devices

Article KB0010041 | Owner: Desktop Support | Subcategory: Keyboard / mouse / headset | Applies to: Windows 11 23H2/24H2 on Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840, macOS 14/15 on MacBook Pro/Air, Acme-managed devices joined to Entra ID/AD and enrolled in Intune

Summary

This article guides users and service-desk agents through pairing Bluetooth peripherals (mouse, keyboard, headset) with Acme-managed laptops and desktops. It covers prerequisites, a self-help troubleshooting flow, verification steps, and the Desktop Support procedure for cases that require agent intervention.

Symptoms

- Mouse cursor does not move or clicks are not registered
- Keyboard keys produce no input or repeat erratically
- Bluetooth headset shows as "Not connected" in Settings; microphone is silent in Teams or other apps
- Error message: "Could not connect to the device. Make sure the device is turned on and discoverable."

Common causes

- Bluetooth radio disabled or in airplane mode
- Device out of range (>10?m) or obstructed
- Peripheral battery low or not in pairing mode
- Previous pairing profile corrupted or stale
- Interference from other wireless devices (Wi-Fi, cordless phones)

Before you start

Ensure the laptop's Bluetooth radio is enabled. On Windows, open Settings -> Bluetooth & devices and toggle Bluetooth to On. On macOS, click the Bluetooth icon in the menu bar or open System Settings -> Bluetooth and verify it is turned on. Make sure the peripheral is charged (or has fresh batteries) and is set to pairing mode - usually by holding the power/button for 3-5 seconds until an LED flashes.

Self-help pairing procedure

Follow these steps to pair or re-pair a Bluetooth mouse, keyboard, or headset. If any step fails, note the exact error message and proceed to the verification section.

1. Open Bluetooth settings: Windows - Settings -> Bluetooth & devices; macOS - System Settings -> Bluetooth.
2. Click "Add device" (Windows) or the "+" button (macOS) to start discovery.
3. Put the peripheral into pairing mode (refer to the manufacturer's guide; typically a blinking LED).
4. When the device appears in the list, select it and click "Connect" (Windows) or "Pair" (macOS).
5. If prompted, confirm the passkey on both the laptop and the peripheral (most modern devices use Just Works and require no input).
6. Wait for the status to change to "Connected". Test the device: move the mouse, type a few keys, or speak into the headset microphone in a test call.

Verification

After completing the self-help steps, verify that the peripheral works as expected. For mice and keyboards, open a blank Notepad file and confirm input. For headsets, place a test call in Microsoft Teams and check that the microphone level moves when you speak and that you hear audio through the earpiece. If the device connects but does not function, continue to the troubleshooting subsection below.

1. Mouse: Move cursor; left- and right-click should register.
2. Keyboard: Type a sentence; all keys should appear.
3. Headset: In Teams, go to Settings -> Devices; ensure the headset is selected for both speaker and microphone. Make a test call and verify audio both ways.

Troubleshooting if pairing fails

If the device does not appear, fails to connect, or connects but does not work, try these additional checks before escalating.

1. Toggle Bluetooth off, wait 10 seconds, then turn it back on.
2. Restart the laptop (this clears the Bluetooth stack).
3. Remove the existing pairing: Windows - Settings -> Bluetooth & devices -> select device -> Remove device; macOS - hover over the device in Bluetooth list -> click the "-" button. Then repeat the pairing procedure.
4. Check for interference: move away from Wi-Fi routers, cordless phones, or other Bluetooth adapters.
5. Update Bluetooth driver: Windows - Device Manager -> Bluetooth -> right-click adapter -> Update driver; macOS - ensure system is up to date via Software Update.

Service Desk procedure (Desktop Support)

When a user reports a Bluetooth peripheral issue and the self-help steps have not resolved it, the Desktop Support agent should follow this workflow. Document each action in the ticket.

1. Verify the user's laptop model and OS version from the asset inventory or ask the user to confirm.
2. Confirm that Bluetooth is enabled and not in airplane mode.
3. Ask the user to describe the exact symptom and any error messages observed.
4. Guide the user through removing the existing Bluetooth pairing and re-adding the device (as in the self-help steps).
5. If the peripheral still does not pair, attempt to pair a known-good spare from Desktop Support stock to isolate whether the fault lies with the laptop or the peripheral.
6. For laptops, check Intune for any compliance policies that might disable Bluetooth; if found, work with the Identity & Access Management team to adjust the policy.
7. If the laptop's Bluetooth adapter is suspected faulty, create a hardware replacement ticket and arrange for a swap per the Desktop Support hardware-replacement process.
8. Close the ticket only after the user confirms the peripheral works in their regular workflow.

Closing and user communication

Once the device is functioning, provide the user with a brief confirmation message and remind them of the self-help steps for future reference. Encourage them to keep the peripheral charged and to re-pair it after any major OS update or after the laptop has been in standby for an extended period.

When to escalate

If the peripheral still fails after the self-help and troubleshooting steps, escalate to Desktop Support. Include the laptop model, OS version, exact error messages, and a summary of steps already performed.

Keywords: Bluetooth, pairing, mouse, keyboard, headset, wireless, peripheral